



Quick breakthrough: Arshdeep's wobble-seam delivery dismissed South African captain Aiden Markram early in the T20 World Cup final. K. R.

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achieved good results by hitting those hard lengths and getting the ball to move around a bit. I also give a lot of credit to the BCCI for encouraging me to take up the county stint. It really helped me improve my red-ball skills as well.

As a T20 specialist, do you aspire to play Test cricket too?

Of course, I dream of donning the whites and bowling with that red cherry. I want to play all three formats, and whenever I have spoken to Jassi bhai, he has told me, *"Tere ko teeno format khelna hai. White ball khelega toh achha hai, but jab tu red ball khelega, you can create a legacy..."* (You have to play all three formats. Playing white ball is good, but when you play red ball, you can create a legacy." He has always motivated me to focus on

red-ball cricket. During most of our conversations, Jassi bhai asks me, *"Tujhe khelna hai red ball?"* and I always tell him that I am very eager to start my red-ball journey with the Indian team.

You spoke about your camaraderie with Bumrah. But on the field, we have often seen Bumrah and Rohit Sharma getting into animated discussions with you, especially during the death overs. How do those discussions go?

(Smiles) Rohit bhai and Jassi bhai are legends. They have been dominating international cricket for a long time. Whenever I have a plan, I ask them whether I can implement it. They take my suggestions into account and the field is set accordingly. That helps me focus on the job at hand. As a batter, Rohit bhai understands which areas trouble the batting unit, so he suggests a thing or two about how to bowl an over, and those little things matter in crunch times.

Jassi bhai is a unique bowler with a different bowling action, so the

things that work for him might not work for others. But he guides me on how to adjust the lengths to get bounce and even suggests areas *jahan pe ball jaldi reverse hoga* (where the ball will reverse quicker). During the World Cup, he told me not to go searching for swing early because on those surfaces, the ball won't swing much, so it was better to hit the hard lengths. He keeps telling me those things throughout the match, and our discussions often get animated because *apna bhi toh young khoon hai, so at times, hum bhi disagree kar jatein hain un ke saath* (I am young, so at times, I do disagree with him) (laughs). But later, I realised that Jassi bhai's suggestions would have worked if I had listened to him. I learn from my mistakes and strive to improve.

Did anything of that sort happen in the T20 World Cup as well?

(Smiles) Yes. Against Afghanistan, the ball was reversing a lot, so he suggested a few field placements. But I thought otherwise and suggested a different field setting.